

CMUnity Constitution

Constitution of CMUnity

Article I: Organization Name

The name of this organization shall be **CMUnity**.

Article II: Mission and Principles

Section 1: Mission Statement

The mission of CMUnity is to foster a campus environment defined by connection, understanding, and active citizenship. We strive to bridge divides within the Carnegie Mellon University community by creating spaces for genuine human connection and constructive dialogue.

Section 2: Core Principles

This organization is founded upon and dedicated to the following principles:

1. **Breaking Cliques and Building Community:** We actively work to dismantle social silos and foster a unified, inclusive campus culture where every individual feels a sense of belonging.
2. **Spreading Respect, Solidarity, and Empathy:** We champion a culture of kindness and mutual understanding, standing in solidarity with one another and treating all individuals with dignity.
3. **Encouraging Civic Engagement:** We promote active participation in the democratic process and civic life, empowering students to be responsible and engaged members of society.
4. **Healing Polarization:** We seek to de-escalate social and political divisiveness by emphasizing shared humanity and common ground over partisan conflict.

5. **Facilitating Thoughtful, Nuanced Discussions:** We provide a platform for substantive conversations on complex issues, valuing depth, nuance, and critical thinking over soundbites and hostility.

All activities and functions of the organization must be legal under University, local, state, and federal laws.

Article III: Membership

Section 1: Eligibility

Membership in CMUnity is open to all registered students (undergraduate and graduate), faculty, staff, and alumni of Carnegie Mellon University.

Section 2: Active Membership

An active member is defined as an individual who:

1. Attends at least three (3) meetings or events per semester.
2. Upholds the principles of the organization, particularly regarding respect and empathy in discussions.

Section 3: Non-Discrimination

CMUnity will not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, gender identity, pregnancy, disability, age, ancestry, veteran status, genetic information, or sexual orientation. We are committed to ensuring the safety and respect of all members of the Carnegie Mellon community. **Harassment, retaliation, or any behavior that makes others feel unsafe, is not tolerated.** CMUnity is committed to abiding by the CMU Statement of Assurance.

Section 4: Recruitment and Voting Rights

1. **Recruitment:** Recruitment for new members shall be open year-round, with primary recruitment drives occurring at the beginning of the Fall and Spring semesters.
2. **Voting Rights:** Only active members in good standing (per Article III, Section 2) are eligible to vote. Affiliate members (faculty and staff) may participate in discussions but may not vote. Alumni members may vote.

Section 5: Reinstatement

Members removed under Article VI may apply for reinstatement after one full semester. Reinstatement requires a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority vote of the Executive Board.

Section 6: Non-Hazing Statement

Hazing will not be used as a condition of membership in this organization. The organization will abide by all University policies regarding student conduct and safety.

Article IV: Officers

Section 1: Executive Board

The Executive Board shall consist of the President, Executive Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Envoy of Civic Pluralism, Chief Envoy of Spiritual Solidarity, and Chief Envoy of Cultural Convergence.

Section 2: Duties

1. **President:** Presides over meetings and represents the organization to the University. The President executes the strategic will of the Executive Board and holds no unilateral power to dissolve the organization, terminate membership, or compel executive resignations.
2. **Executive Vice President:** Assists the President and presides in their absence. In the event of a documented conflict of interest involving the President, the EVP shall assume presiding duties over relevant administrative inquiries.
3. **Secretary:** Maintains records of meetings (minutes), manages membership lists, and coordinates communication, ensuring transparency in all discussions.
4. **Treasurer:** Manages finances, keeps accurate accounts, and coordinates funding for events.
5. **Chief Technology Officer (CTO):** Responsible for digital infrastructure and maintaining platforms for nuanced dialogue. The CTO is specifically charged with managing the organization's website and may delegate technical tasks to trustworthy assistants as they see fit.
6. **Chief Envoy of Civic Pluralism:** Responsible for leading bipartisan initiatives, facilitating cross-partisan dialogue, and bridging political divides within the campus community.
7. **Chief Envoy of Spiritual Solidarity:** Responsible for leading interfaith initiatives, promoting religious pluralism, and building multi-faith community solidarity.

8. **Chief Envoy of Cultural Convergence:** Responsible for leading initiatives that bridge cultural divides, celebrating the diverse backgrounds of the university community, and promoting cross-cultural understanding.

Section 3: Officer Conduct & Communication

To ensure a safe professional environment, the following protocols are mandated:

1. **Professional Boundaries:** Executive communication regarding organizational business must occur in official group channels (e.g., Exec Chat) or scheduled meetings.
2. **Conflict Mediation:** Any interpersonal dispute that impacts organizational operations must be referred to the Faculty Advisor for mediation before any executive action is proposed.
3. **No-Contact Mandate:** The Executive Board reserves the right to mandate professional-only communication between officers to prevent harassment or retaliation.

Section 4: Eligibility and Restrictions

1. **Eligibility:** To be eligible for office, a member must be a currently registered Carnegie Mellon student.
2. **Concurrent Positions:** No officer may hold more than one position on the Executive Board concurrently, unless a position becomes vacant and no other active member is available to fill it, in which case the Executive Board may authorize a temporary dual-role.
3. **Officer Voting:** All officers have full voting rights on the Executive Board. However, in general body meetings, the President shall only vote in the event of a tie.

Section 5: Terms of Office

Officers shall serve for one academic year. Elections will be held in the Spring semester for the following year.

Article V: Elections

Section 1: Procedure

1. **Timing and Notification:** Elections shall be held annually during the Spring semester, typically at the second-to-last general meeting. Active members must be notified of the election date, time, and location at least two (2) weeks in advance. Notifications may include email, flyers, posters,

verbal announcements at meetings, social media posts, or updates to the CMUnity website.

2. **Nominations:** Any active member may nominate themselves or another active member for office. Nominations will be accepted starting one meeting prior to the elections and up until the start of the voting process.
3. **Voting Process:** Officers are elected by a simple majority vote (51%) of active members present at the election meeting. A quorum of at least 50% of the total active student membership must be present for elections to be valid. Candidates shall be elected in the following order: President, Executive Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Envoy of Civic Pluralism, Chief Envoy of Spiritual Solidarity, and Chief Envoy of Cultural Convergence. Each candidate shall be given the opportunity to make a brief statement (no more than 3 minutes) before voting begins for their position.
4. **Tie-Breaking and Run-offs:** In the event of a tie, a run-off election between the tied candidates will be held immediately. If several candidates are running and none receive 51% of the vote, the top two candidates will proceed to a run-off.
5. **Absentee Ballots:** Absentee or proxy ballots are not permitted; members must be present to vote.

Section 2: Formal Censure

The Executive Board may, by a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority vote, issue a **Formal Letter of Censure** to an officer. This serves as an official reprimand and a permanent record of misconduct without requiring removal from office.

Section 3: Voting

Voting shall be conducted by secret ballot to ensure fairness.

Section 4: Transition

The transition from old officers to new officers will take place during the final meeting of the Spring semester. Newly elected officers shall officially assume their positions at the conclusion of this meeting.

Article VI: Removal and Vacancies

Section 1: Grounds for Removal of Officers or Members

Officers or members may be removed for conduct that blatantly contradicts the core principles of the organization (e.g., harassment, fostering polarization, or engaging in discriminatory behavior) or for failure to perform duties.

Section 2: Process

1. A motion for removal must be brought by an active member and seconded.
2. The individual in question must be given the opportunity to speak in their defense.
3. Removal requires a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority vote of the voting members present.

Section 3: Appeals

The process for appeals can be initiated by either a member in good standing or by the individual removed with a sponsor who is a member in good standing. Appeals must be filed within five (5) business days of the removal decision. The appeal shall be heard by the Executive Board within ten (10) business days of receipt. The Board's decision on the appeal shall be final and binding.

Section 4: Re-election

Officers may be re-elected to the same or a different position for a maximum of two (2) consecutive one-year terms.

Section 5: Vacancies

1. **President Vacancy:** In the event that the office of President is vacated, the Executive Vice President shall assume the office of President for the remainder of the term.
2. **Other Vacancies:** For any other Executive Board vacancy, the President may appoint an interim officer with the approval of a majority of the remaining Executive Board. A special election shall be held at the next general body meeting to permanently fill the position.

Article VII: Meetings

Section 1: Types of Meetings

1. **General Body Meetings:** Held at least monthly during the academic year to facilitate discussions and community events. All members are invited to attend. Only active student members in good standing are eligible to vote at general body meetings.
2. **Executive Board Meetings:** Held at least bi-weekly to manage organization operations. Only officers are required to attend, though they may invite other members. Only officers with voting rights (per Article IV, Section 4) are eligible to vote at these meetings.

Section 2: Calling Meetings and Notice

1. **Regular Meetings:** The President or a majority of the Executive Board may call a general body meeting with at least one week's notice.
2. **Emergency Meetings:** The President and Executive Vice President can call emergency meetings with a 24-hour notice to the active membership.

Section 3: Quorum and Procedures

1. **Quorum:** A quorum for conducting general business at any meeting shall consist of at least 50% of the active student membership.
2. **Procedural Rules:** Meetings shall be conducted in accordance with *Robert's Rules of Order (Revised)*, except where they conflict with this Constitution.
3. **Format:** Meetings shall be structured to encourage dialogue. Moderators may be designated to ensure discussions remain respectful, nuanced, and productively align with the principle of healing polarization.

Article VIII: Advisor

Section 1: Selection

The Executive Board shall nominate and select a faculty or staff advisor from Carnegie Mellon University. The advisor must be approved by a majority vote of the Executive Board.

Section 2: Role and Responsibility

The advisor shall serve as a resource person and provide advisory support for the officers and members of the organization. The advisor has no voting rights in the organization.

Section 3: Term and Removal

The advisor shall serve for an unspecified term at the pleasure of the Executive Board. An advisor may be removed by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Board. In the event of removal or resignation, a new advisor shall be selected within thirty (30) school days.

Article IX: Finances

Section 1: Funding and Dues

1. **Funding:** CMUnity may raise funds through university funding, grants, or voluntary contributions.
2. **Dues:** No membership dues are required at this time. Any future implementation of dues must be approved by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the active student membership.

Section 2: Expenditures and Budget

1. **Authorized Signatures:** All financial transactions require the authorization of the Treasurer and the President. In cases of a presidential conflict of interest, the EVP shall serve as the second signatory.
2. **Budget Approval:** An annual budget must be prepared by the Treasurer and approved by a majority of the Executive Board at the start of each Fall semester.
3. **Legal Limitation:** Organizational funds may be spent on items such as office supplies, events/activities, publicity, travel expenses, and conference fees, but will not be used for anything illegal under University, local, state, and federal laws.
4. **Handover:** The outgoing Treasurer must ensure a full transfer of all financial records and account access to the incoming Treasurer during the transition period.

Article X: Amendments

Section 1: Proposal

Amendments to this constitution may be proposed by any active member at a general meeting.

Section 2: Ratification

1. Proposed amendments must be presented at least one meeting prior to voting.
2. Ratification requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active members present.

Section 3: Effective Date

Amendments shall take effect immediately upon ratification unless a different effective date is specified in the amendment itself.

Article XI: Ratification

This Constitution shall become effective immediately upon a majority vote of the founding members of CMUnity.

Article XII: Institutional Continuity and Handovers

Section 1: Handover Mandate

To preserve organizational continuity and stability, all outgoing executive officers must facilitate a formal handover process for their successors. This process is designed to ensure that CMUnity retains all institutional knowledge, strategic resources, and operational assets across leadership transitions.

Section 2: Resource Management

The handover process must include the transfer of access to all digital platforms, financial accounts, and organizational archives. Specifically, the Executive Board shall maintain and manage a collective password manager to secure all organizational credentials.

Section 3: Responsibility

While all members of the Executive Board bear collective responsibility for the success of the handover process and the security of organizational resources, the **Chief Technology Officer (CTO)** is primarily responsible for the technical implementation and maintenance of the collective password manager and digital archives.

Article XIII: History

1. **Constitution Created:** February 19th, 2026
2. **Constitution Revised:** February 26th, 2026 (Compliance Update)
3. **Constitution Revised:** August 10th, 2026 (Officer titles, conduct protocols, and censure)